

ORDER HAIL MARY

The Decentralized Sovereignty Failsafe Doctrine

An open proposal — to the United States, and to every nation that intends to survive its worst day.

Document II of the Decentralized Sovereignty canon.

Preamble: The Play You Never Want to Call

A Hail Mary is not a play you invent in the moment. It is designed in calm, drilled in peace, and thrown only in desperation — which means the entire outcome is decided long before the ball is in the air.

Nations understand this. They build continuity-of-government bunkers, doomsday aircraft, seed vaults in arctic mountains. Serious plans, built by serious people. But nearly all of them share one structural flaw: they are centralized failsafes protecting centralized systems. The backup generator wired to the same grid. The recovery database hosted in the same cloud. The chain of command that assumes the chain still exists.

Every centralized failsafe shares fate with the system it protects. A backup stored in the burning building is called kindling.

Order Hail Mary is the other kind of failsafe: civilization's continuity held by everyone, everywhere, all the time. Not a bunker. A posture. Not a red button. A standing order.

This is not a plan against any government — least of all our own. It is the layer beneath government, for the day when no plan above it survives contact with reality. A resilient nation should want this layer to exist. A wise one would help build it.

Part I — The Threat Model

No hysteria. Just the short list every serious resilience planner already keeps.

A grid-scale cyberattack that turns off power for weeks, not hours. A financial seizure — clearing systems halted, banks shuttered, a currency in freefall — where money still exists but stops *moving*. A pandemic with a sharper edge than the last one. Great-power conflict that reaches infrastructure long before it reaches territory. A Carrington-class solar storm, the kind that has hit this planet before and will again, indifferent to whether we're ready. Or the quiet one: cascading failure of AI-dependent systems that no single human fully understands anymore.

Different triggers. Identical failure signature. **The centralized layer fails first and takes everything downstream with it.** When the datacenter dies, the app dies. When the clearing

system halts, your balance becomes a rumor. When the tower falls, your phone is a flashlight.

Modern civilization runs about nine meals and one authentication server deep. That is not a criticism. It is a design spec for what must come next.

Part II — The Principle: Failsafes Must Not Share Fate

Engineers have a phrase for the discipline that keeps airplanes in the sky: *independent failure domains*. The backup must not fail for the same reason as the primary. It must not sit in the same building, run on the same power, trust the same authority, or require the same permission.

Follow that logic honestly and it arrives at exactly one architecture.

A last-resort system for civilization must have no headquarters to hit, no CEO to subpoena, no server to seize, no switch to flip. It must be so distributed that destroying it means destroying everyone — at which point there is nothing left to fail over anyway.

In peacetime, decentralization is a preference. In catastrophe, it is the only architecture left standing.

That is Order Hail Mary's entire theoretical core: **the properties that make decentralized systems inconvenient to control are the same properties that make them impossible to kill**. We spent a decade debating the first half of that sentence. The second half is the failsafe.

Part III — The Six Protocols

Order Hail Mary is composed of six protocols. Each carries a standing order — something ordinary people execute now, in daylight, while it's easy.

Protocol I — SIGNAL

Communications continuity: no single tower between two humans.

The first thing every collapse takes is the ability to coordinate — and coordination is the whole difference between a hard year and a dark age. The failsafe is a communications fabric with no center: mesh networks that hop device to device, long-range low-power radio, amateur bands that have carried traffic through every disaster of the last century, and when all else fails, data walked from one node to the next. Every additional node is redundancy no one can confiscate.

Standing order: own one way to communicate that requires no company, no tower, and no subscription — and know how to use it before you need it.

Protocol II — LEDGER

Value continuity: money that works when the banks don't open.

Commerce is how strangers cooperate. The failsafe for money is self-custody — value held by keys, not permissions — on ledgers replicated across so many machines that no failure, seizure, or decree can halt them, paired with transactions that can be signed offline and settled when connectivity returns. Communities that can still trade are communities that don't unravel.

Standing order: hold at least some of what you own with your own keys, and understand the difference between money you possess and money you're permitted to use.

Protocol III — NAME

Identity continuity: prove who you are when the databases are ash.

Modern identity is a row in someone else's database — and rows burn. The failsafe is cryptographic identity: keys you generate and keep, attestations from people and institutions who know you, a web of trust that reconstructs reputation without a registrar. When the records are gone, your key still signs. Your history, your credentials, your name of last resort — carried by you, vouched by many, dependent on no office that can close.

Standing order: establish keys today and let your community attest to them. Identity, like every protocol here, only works as a failsafe if it exists before the failure.

Protocol IV — LIBRARY

Knowledge continuity: a seed vault for know-how.

Civilization is not buildings. It is knowing how — medicine, sanitation, agriculture, water, power, engineering, law. Today that knowledge lives behind logins, on servers, in clouds that require the very infrastructure a catastrophe removes. The failsafe is the distributed library: complete offline archives of humanity's critical knowledge, small enough to sit on a drive, cheap enough to put in every home, school, and town hall on Earth. Ten thousand copies of how to make water safe and set a bone, everywhere, forever. Burn any of them. You cannot burn all of them.

Standing order: keep one offline archive of essential knowledge and one skill practiced deeply enough to teach. Be a page of the library.

Protocol V — MIND

Compute continuity: intelligence that doesn't need a datacenter.

We are wiring civilization's judgment into AI hosted in a handful of buildings. Whatever else that is, it is a single point of failure for thinking. The failsafe is local intelligence: open-source models running on ordinary hardware — the garage cluster, the desktop, the laptop on solar — able to reason through triage, repair, farming, and logistics with no connection to

anything. The library stores what humanity knows. The mind applies it at 3 a.m. when no expert can be reached. Every capable open model in private hands is a lifeboat for judgment itself.

Standing order: if you have the hardware, run a local model and learn what it can and cannot do — calibration you must build before you're relying on it.

Protocol VI — COUNCIL

Governance continuity: recovery has a protocol, or recovery has warlords.

The most dangerous vacuum after a collapse is not food or power. It is legitimacy. History is blunt about what fills an unprepared one. The failsafe is agreeing on the rules of cooperation before they're needed: transparent, consent-based decision protocols a community adopts in daylight — how resources pool, how disputes settle, how decisions get made and recorded, how neighboring communities federate back into something larger. Written down, practiced in small things, ready for large ones. Not a government in waiting. A constitution for the meantime — with an expiration date and an audit trail.

Standing order: know your people. The protocol layer of last resort is trust between humans who've practiced cooperating — and no technology replaces it.

Part IV — Rules of Activation

Here is the part that makes Order Hail Mary different from every bunker ever built:

There is no activation.

A failsafe that must be switched on is a failsafe that can fail to switch — the general who can't be reached, the seals rusted shut, the protocol no one drilled. So this doctrine has no switch. The mesh you message on, the keys you already hold, the model in your garage, the archive on your shelf, the community rules you already practice — the failsafe is simply daily life, built on rails that don't require permission to run.

The backup that isn't running isn't a backup. It's a hope with good branding.

Peacetime utility is the drill. Every ordinary day these systems serve you is a day the failsafe was tested and passed.

Part V — To the United States, and Every Serious Nation

Read this doctrine as what it is: not a threat to sovereignty, but the deepest form of it.

A nation whose citizens hold their own keys cannot have its economy switched off from abroad. A nation with a mesh in every city cannot be silenced by taking towers. A nation with the library in every town and the mind in every garage cannot lose its knowledge or its judgment to any single strike. A nation of self-sufficient nodes has no single head to take — it cannot be decapitated, and it cannot collapse, because collapse requires a center.

Continuity of government is a noble plan for a few hundred officials. **Order Hail Mary is continuity of civilization, for everyone else.** The two are not rivals. One protects the state's ability to decide. The other protects the people's ability to endure. A wise state funds both — and treats every self-reliant citizen not as a suspect, but as critical infrastructure.

To citizens: the six standing orders above are the whole ask. Hours, not heroics.

To builders: build offline-first, open-source, and boring. In this doctrine, "boring and unkillable" outranks "innovative and fragile" every single time.

Epilogue: Run the Play in Daylight

We hope this document ages into irrelevance — a strange artifact from people who prepared for a day that never came. That would be the good ending.

But hope is not an architecture.

The manifesto said sovereignty is not granted, it is built. Here is the corollary: **in peacetime, Decentralized Sovereignty is prosperity. In catastrophe, it is the difference between a dark age and a hard year.** Same systems. Same keys. Same networks. One future where they make life freer, and one where they carry it through the fire.

Order Hail Mary is already live. It activates a little more every time someone holds their own keys, mirrors the library, meshes a neighborhood, boots a local model, or writes down how their community decides. No ceremony. No announcement. Just quiet redundancy accumulating against the worst day.

The play is designed. Run it now, in daylight — so it never has to be thrown in desperation.

● Build the failsafe. ● Trust the building never burns.

You decide.

Document II of the Decentralized Sovereignty canon. A living doctrine — argue with it, fork it, improve it, mirror it.

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#OpenSource #Preparedness #Web3